

Timestamp	On a scale from 1 to 10, how effectively did Justin explain complex linear algebra concepts during the lectures or office hours?	Please provide specific examples or instances of good or bad teaching from Justin that stood out to you.	On a scale from 1 to 10, how helpful were the videos / recordings I released for exam review?	How could the videos / recordings mentioned in the previous question be improved?	If Justin was teaching this class he would do the following differently. Do you have any comments?	Write anything else here:
12/19/2023 18:54:08	10	really hard working TA, he makes clear the intention behind teaching certain important topics such as eigenvalues, determinants, etc. He also specifically explains why we are doing a certain step such as why we need to calculate the inverse of something.	10	Just mention a little bit more of the theory behind it, that's all :)	Sounds good 1. The class would begin with Chapter 5 so that students have a stronger foundation in linear algebra theory before applying it to things like Markov chains. 2. The Leslie model would be omitted in favor of either principle component analysis, Fourier analysis, or differential equations. 3. The first 2 lectures of the course would provide an overview of the course. Essentially, the first two lectures would be like Justin's Midterm review session and Final exam review session. Doing it this way will illustrate the purpose of the course and prime students for learning it.	Thank you Justin for making this class easier than it sounds to be. I hope you go far in your career at SBU and beyond.
12/19/2023 18:56:20	10		8		1. Absolutely 2. I think the Leslie model should be taught briefly alongside any of those other topics as it is a good continuation of transition matrices. 3. Yes	
12/19/2023 18:56:29	10	Very high quality with very good explanation	10	N/A	N/A	N/A
12/19/2023 18:56:45	10	He made things make more sense	9	they got a little rushed at the end because the class was about to but otherwise they were very good.	this would make it incredibly more easy to understand and it would be less confusing in the beginning	
12/19/2023 18:56:54	9		10		N/A	
12/19/2023 18:59:39	10		10		This would be helpful	
12/19/2023 19:02:05	10	He was very succinct and to the point when teaching the modules. He also made sure to explain fundamental concepts.	10	Timestamps would have been useful, but are probably too troublesome to implement. The current version of the recordings is perfectly fine.	I approve, though I have little input on #2 since I haven't learnt those.	Amazing TA
12/19/2023 19:05:33	8		8		Agree with all of above	
12/19/2023 19:06:27	9		10		I agree with the first point. Personally, I have taken Linear Algebra previously in high school, and it was much more theory based (concepts such as linear independence/combinations, spanning sets, vector spaces were taught very early on). While taking this course, I felt like if I did not have a prior rigorous understanding of Linear, I would not have been able to grasp applications such as Markov Chains as thoroughly. Of course the argument could be made that this is an Applied Math course, but I do believe it is necessary to thoroughly understand a concept before discussing its potential applications—otherwise one would wonder why specifically that concept is being utilized.	Thank you for being a great TA!
12/19/2023 19:09:53	10	Explains concepts very clear	10			1 Amazing job. 100/10
12/19/2023 19:12:29	10	He would explain to us the use of each concept. Giving us the background helped me understand why I needed to do each step of the process.	10	Not sure	I strongly agree with the first and last one. Moving chapter 5 to the beginning would be easier for students.	I only came to class for those reviews
12/19/2023 19:27:08	10		10		I agree with this method.	
12/19/2023 19:27:44	10		10			2
12/19/2023 19:34:32	10	Justin went through exam topics such as eigenvectors, eigenvalues, and linear regression very well. The examples he went over in the review were very reflective of what was expected on the exams given. Overall, Justin was very helpful for my success in this class.	10	Trimmed down into smaller sections regarding each individual topic, just to make it simpler to find the subtopic you are looking for when studying	I agree, as it was quite confusing to grasp certain concepts such as Markov chains without going over the contents of chapter 5 first. Additionally, at the start of the course felt like I needed to understand why I was doing said math too quickly. Thus, I agree with the third point, understanding why we are doing the math would help with understanding moving forward	Good looks gang

12/19/2023 19:36:52	10	When he did midterm 1 review. I picked up everything really fast. Before the review, i was lost at sea.	10	Same as before, i understood everything after watching one lecture	I love all the changes	
12/19/2023 19:48:05	9	Any time he gave a lecture he expained the concepts very well and was easy to follow.	8	Sometimes the audio and visual were in different vids, but besides that they were very helpful.	No, I agree that chapter 5 should have been earlier, it would have made the class flow much easier.	Thanks for teaching this semester
12/19/2023 19:50:14	10		10		None	
12/19/2023 20:03:23	10	Uh he replied like really fast in his emails and was pretty kind and efficient in his responses. Uhhhh honestly I uh never really had to do the study sheet because he explained it in class really well. He also realized that he graded some of the midterms harshly and even though I didn't complain he made sure that I got the score I deserved, which takes a lot of effort and time especially cuz I never said anything about my score so I was surprised.	10	Really helpful	I had a great experience.	Have a great break!
12/19/2023 20:05:49	10	Very good teacher, all the review sessions were amazing	10		I think #3 might not be the best idea. An overview of the class might make some students not pay attention until the first real lecture since they don't know anything.	
12/19/2023 20:10:48	10	Reviews of midterms and finals posted are extremely helpful.	10	Fine the way they are now.		1 Fantastic job for this course.
12/19/2023 20:11:48	10	He explains concepts in an efficient manner that is understandable and he has many tips to understand even complex concepts. It is also evident that he wants students to succeed with the amount of resources he provides and dedication he has.	10		I think these are good improvements	
12/19/2023 20:29:00	10	Great formatting, saves notes, and records himself doing assignments for us to check over.	10	Maybe have better tablet to write in a more organized way. ex. smaller font less slanted writing. Overall great tho.	AMAZING	You're amazing thank you
12/19/2023 20:29:35	9	I appreciated how everything was step-by-step and the pacing was at a good speed.	8		In my opinon, I am unsure of the 3rd point (final exam review session being the first lecture of the course) -- I think it would be nice to have an overview of the course but it might be a bit overwhelming to begin with. I liked how the first lecture in this class was essentially a review of basic algebra (so we felt like we were easing into the course). Then again, I do not think this was as helpful for understanding linear algebra, so if done in a slow manner, I think the third point would help future students.	Thank you for the review sessions! They were extremely helpful.
12/19/2023 20:31:08	8	The review sessions were good at covering things that would be on the test, and they were very useful. Explanation were clear. I would have preferred harder examples for each topic.	8	They were good at explaining what needed to be understood but a topic but the examples could be better. Maybe more depth about a topic to further help understand it.	I would agree with most of this. The first lecture could give general ideas on each topic and how everything ties together, as well as applications of these concepts in real life. I did not like the structure of 210 because it felt more like learning how to calculate and solve things instead of actually learning linear algebra. Understanding the foundation better would probably make it easier to understand the "applied" part of the course.	
12/19/2023 20:36:43	8	Instances of good teaching from Justin that stood out to me was explaining some of the applications og the topic that sometimes exceeded the explanations from the professor himself. When it comes to preparing us for tests, Justin's review sessions and willingness to help us ace our exams stood out to me. As semester approaches to an end however, some of the review sessions were a bit hard to follow.	9	The videos and recordings have helped outline topics tested on the exams.	I think that would be better for the course.	

12/19/2023 20:43:08	9	I went to office hours once when I was having trouble with the last homework assignment (problem related to the Leslie Model), as my answer was not matching the answer key. Justin cleared up the confusion I had within a couple minutes. He's good at explaining how the concepts we learned connect to each other, especially the last handful of units in the curriculum.	10		This sounds great, I wish the course was taught to us in this way, it would've made the class less frustrating and confusing. I did not like that all the ideas connected only during the last week of classes, the whole semester I was confused as to what all these procedures and applications to the matrix meant/why we are learning this, and I think if it was taught in this suggested order above, I would've liked the class and spent less time teaching myself the material. I also think teaching differential equations would be useful because a lot of the linear algebra YouTube videos and online resources cover that topic, however Kozakov did not mention it at all. Maybe you could also post on Brightspace some youtube video links related to the topic the students are learning, the visuals in some of those videos really help make the matrix stuff seem meaningful and useful.	Thank you for being a good TA!
12/19/2023 20:45:26	10		8	Captions	This is the way it should have been done.	
12/19/2023 20:59:23	10		10		You're the GOAT.	
12/19/2023 21:05:35	10		10		n/a	thank you !
12/19/2023 21:52:59	10		10		This would be great.	
12/19/2023 21:53:07	10	Super sUPER responsible	10		Strongly agree with the first one	
12/19/2023 21:53:59	8		10		Strongly agree with the first one	
12/19/2023 21:55:54	10	I liked that the lectures were easier to follow (compared to Prof.) The lectures were short, simple, and straight to the point. Plus, there was almost always time to ask questions or to go over problems that didn't make sense.	10	I think they were really good and I don't have complaints with them.	Based on my experience in this course, I would say that number 3 would be most helpful for students. Although 1 and 2 are also definitely helpful, 3 would be the best because it would help give students insight into what they would be learning throughout the semester. It could help make them more aware of topics and lessons that seem challenging and/or difficult for them, which would help them study in advance and make notes to do extra learning or go to office hours.	I think Justin really helped make this course an easy and smooth experience. He did a great job keeping the class engaged and maintaining a fun environment for learning.
12/19/2023 22:18:46	10	Every exam review, Justin does a great job of helping us review the material and does a wonderful job explaining the concepts in an easy to understand manner.	10	I believe there were some issues with the uploading/recording but overall I think it still was great.	I do like the idea of the 3rd bullet point as its easier to understand material when you have an idea of the great picture.	Great job overall, made this course much more enjoyable and less stressful.
12/19/2023 22:43:17	9	Very good review for tests	10		All of the above	
12/19/2023 23:57:00	10	Exam reviews are helpful	10	he could be more thorough for some parts	i like the implementation of 3 because I learn most in his review sessions	
12/20/2023 0:04:43	10	Justin explained the concepts very well, not just telling us how to do the calculations but explaining the theory and reasoning for certain things. His explanations were very clear too and I probably would not have done as well in the class if not for him.	10		We would still need to learn about matrices and stuff first, and I don't really think the textbook explained the geometry and stuff about that and vectors well enough so maybe go a little into that.	
12/20/2023 0:11:21	10		9		All very good ideas. Definitely should not introduce vector space in the middle of the semestar.	
12/20/2023 0:46:50	10		10		This would be beneficial!	
12/20/2023 10:02:27	10		10		i agree	
12/20/2023 10:32:37	10		10		I agree	
12/20/2023 11:01:45	9	He was a clear teacher, and gave us outside resources to further our understanding, as well as recording the lectures.	9	They were good in and of themselves, but maybe some extra practice could be added.	I took an introduction to Linear Algebra class in high school using the Gilbert Strang textbook, and I have to say this course was much more confusing as far as theory goes. Definitely begin with vectors and vector spaces, inverses, elimination by pivoting, and eigenvectors. etc. and a strong geometric understanding of Linear Algebra also goes a long way. We also really didn't talk about spanning a space or the left null space. The Leslie Model was a decent application of eigenvectors and I didn't hate it, but I can see how you feel it was unnecessary. The overview is definitely important, but I feel like you kind of pick up the meaning as you learn the basics so I would say 2 lectures for overview is probably ideal if syllabus review is also included in the first lecture.	Thank you!
12/20/2023 11:24:15	10	When he does the reviews for the exam he explains the concept and the reasons of how to solve a certain problem in an simple and easy way for us to understand	10	Nothing, I think it's good enough	Very good	N/A

12/20/2023 11:28:56	10	I love Justin, I wish he was the professor instead of Kozakov. Justin explains things so much clearer.	10	They're pretty good	Class beginning at chapter 5 sounds good. The 3rd point also sounds really good	I love you Justin!!!!!!
12/20/2023 12:19:05	10	Made all the concepts super easy to understand and very straightforward! The notes are organized really well, since for each topic there was the general overview/definition, then methods/ways to solve it or solve for it, its applications, and then an example. I also really appreciate that the notes are legible.	10		I think implementing these would really help students learn better, especially when starting off with Markov chains was a bit confusing. It'll also help if each lesson was recorded, or the general concepts were outlined / summarized for each class since sometimes the board is very difficult to read.	Thank you for the midterm and final review sessions, they were extremely helpful, time-efficient, and straight-forward. Good luck in your academic pursuit!
12/20/2023 20:54:09	10	I remember attending an office hour where you explained how gaussian elimination can help find eigen vectors if $r_1 = r_2$. I thought that was neat. In general, during the reviews, I understood the topics holistically compared to when I had to sort through the notes and textbook when I did hw problems.	10	I'm not sure if this problem can be fixed or not, but on bright space the videos aren't as interactable as YT videos, at least on windows laptop, because it doesn't allow me to slide the time as I please, but rather divides the videos in short intervals I can skip back to. Sometimes I gotta hear the immediate stuff you say multiple times, if I have to go back 1-2 minutes before, it gets a bit annoying to wait again. But then again, that could be a bright space issue as oppose to zoom recording and after all, having a recording to work with in the first place is wonderful.	I like the first two takes, the third/last take could potentially be a bit rough if you proceed exactly like you did during the review session. Instead of going over problems, why don't you talk about terminology and how certain topics correlate with each other more than others: Ex: standard markov vs transitional markov, determinants vs null space, or matrix-matrix matrix-vector and vector-vector operations vs matrix augmentation (transpose, inverses, etc.). I feel like you can reinforce the purpose of the course during the review sessions with those examples and even actual applications because those 3 review sessions should serve as the reminder of purpose at a nice pace as oppose to laying it all out at once, although you'd still probably do the 3 review sessions on top of the introductory lectures. But who knows, maybe doing that could get their interests peaked and actually want to engage with the topics you cover. If you do talk about content at a review level depth, consider discussing the geometric application rather than numerical examples.	It was a pleasure to have you as a TA, hope I helped evaluate you.
12/20/2023 21:52:19	8		10		Most likely agree	the g.o.a.t
12/20/2023 22:45:22	10	He explains stuff much better than the professor. I understand concepts better when explained by Justin. He should teach the course.	10	Use Echo 360 if possible.	I like that much better. This class didn't focus enough on the concepts in Chapter 5, which are important parts of linear algebra. It feels like we really did matrix algebra in the class.	
12/21/2023 1:24:40	10	Nothing bad tbh maybe can talk a little louder and be more concise but everything was perfect! Maybe point out common mistakes people may make. Also little practice assignments (not graded like the hw) that go over each little topic clearer. Maybe go over the assignments for 5 minutes to show the class how to answer a questions See the thing with professors now are they just teach the subject and don't care how they info is consumed. For example a coding class like 114 the teacher would just explain the fundamentals and stuff blah blah blah everything but giving students a clear idea on how to use the info to answer the questions.	10	Recordings were great I really loved them! I wish more ta's were this good. Only improvisation would be to go over different instances of a problem so students know what can be or may happen.	I like this but i feel like the first two lectures thing would be dense and very hard material. Especially since many freshman's are taking this class. Maybe turn it into like 3-4 lectures watever u see fit	Great TA! Probably the best TA i've had and will have. Literally 0 complaints! Great dude just overall a great person. I really hope you well and people like you are really hard to come by. Gave me hope that the future might be in great hands! Very understanding too like I don't know how ur such a good person
12/21/2023 1:25:03	10		10		Idk	
12/21/2023 16:40:04	10		10		I like this arrangement of the course because I think the fundamental concepts of linear algebra would be more solidified.	Thank you for being such a great TA!
12/21/2023 19:57:02	10		10		Yeah, I think it's good idea	
12/21/2023 20:13:05	10		10	Maybe the writing, but everything else was very helpful.	These points seem reasonable.	
12/21/2023 21:01:25	9	For the most part, everything I learned this semester was from these review lectures, since the professor's lectures were quite subpar. I can't think of much you could've done better, the reviews you held taught the content very well.	7	I didn't look at the videos/recordings very much, since I just took a lot of notes from the main review sessions you held in person. I occasionally looked at them for clarification at points where my notes were unclear or unfinished, and normally I found a satisfying answer quickly.	1. Its kind of hard for me to imagine starting from the 5th chapter since we didn't actually do it, but I could see it working decently well. 3. Your midterm review sessions were very helpful, so if they were like that then yeah I think that would be great. The only issue I'd have with it is that since we wouldn't have actually gone over any content before the first 2 lectures, I'm not sure if doing this would be as good as the review sessions were. If you had important enough stuff to say for these though, then yeah I think it would work.	

12/22/2023 11:15:16	8		10	I like the changes but i would also hope to include more work with the grqphing and visual representation kf matrices. I am aware that operations scale, transform, rotate planes in dofferent ways, but I would love to see that in class as it would give students something to imagine and help them intuitively understand concepts.	
12/22/2023 15:09:33	8	good teaching -explains real-world use of certain skills -explains geometric meaning -records lectures -relatable, gives personal tips on how he calculates things bad teaching -sometimes rushes at the end of the lecture -tests are mostly surface level skills-based, may not give good sense of linear algebra for the future	5	I never ended up watching the videos, but they're good to have in general (I watch recordings a lot for my cs classes)	Thanks for being a great TA!
12/23/2023 15:41:14	10		10		3
12/23/2023 20:47:08	10	I think that any time I ever approached Justin after class to clarify a topic he may have explained or something I saw in the textbook that I didn't understand, he was more than knowledgeable, he was incredibly understanding and meticulous in explaining it in some alternative way to help me understand.	10	make sure you're recording. just kidding, they're perfect!	Justin is quite literally the best TA or assistant of any kind that I've had in my semesters in college and my advanced classes in highschool. He is not only knowledgeable, but he is probably one of the friendliest people I've met on campus. He has such a pure and genuine feeling every time I've spoken to him that just makes me want to learn. It always feels like he actually cares about us learning how to apply the work and why it makes sense to use that method over other ones. I have never felt like my needs have been taken care of by any other TA.
12/25/2023 13:16:22	10		10		
12/26/2023 8:08:11	10	When explaining null spaces and determinants, Justin explained them on a conceptual level, making me understand how they work from a geometric standpoint.	10	I completely agree with these hypothetical changes, and if Justin were the one to teach Linear Algebra, I would expect marked improvement in the fluidity of the course under this revised structure.	
12/28/2023 17:24:57	10	Explained applications of the concepts in the real world including robotics and machine learning. Explained topics thoroughly and answered questions.	10		Great TA, really helped me do well in the class and understand the concepts. Office hours was super helpful and review lectures from him.
1/1/2024 10:46:11	10	In every review session, he would thoroughly teach the material that our professor had taught. He was knowledgeable in Linear Algebra because he would simplify anything our professor confused me on when he taught.	10	The first midterm review video went into a step by step solution to how to do certain problems on the review sheet. It was very helpful as it answered many of my questions when I needed help on certain problems in midterm #1 review.	He was an outstanding TA for the class. He answered questions thoroughly and quickly responded whenever I had a question. He did a lot of work and was a great TA for running extra help sessions. He helped me succeed in this class as I was no longer confused by the material he retaught in review or Office Hours. Thanks so much Justin!
1/2/2024 19:13:18	10	He truly understands what he's teaching and presents it in a way that's easy to learn. The lectures are straight to the point with an intuition of why something exists. He doesn't teach 1:1 from the textbook (a good thing) and provides explanations. Before midterm 2, I was struggling with row reduction, but Justin's midterm review helped me understand it much better.	10	The videos and recordings were the best way to study for the tests. It would be better if they were through Echo 360 (higher quality).	
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[1] Responder updated this value.